

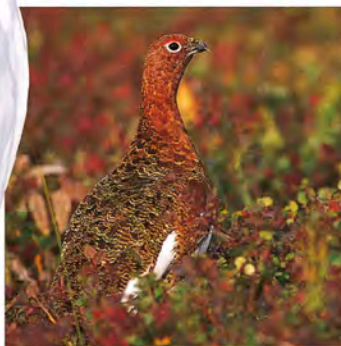


Tough ptarmigans survive the winter by eating dwarf willow twigs.

Birds have a third eyelid that is see-through and helps keep their eyes moist.

Ptarmigans shiver to keep warm.

Snow-colored feathers camouflage ptarmigans.



Summer coat

Willow ptarmigans don't need thick, white coats in the warm summer, so they molt and grow dark red feathers.

Just like big, woolly socks, these feathers keep the ptarmigan's legs, feet, and toes warm.

Causing a stir

Red phalaropes reach the insects that live at the bottom of lakes by swimming in circles! This stirs up the water and makes the insects float upward. You can try this too—put some buttons in a bowl of water, stir it up, and watch!



Duck down

Eider ducks pluck soft feathers, called down, from their breast to line their nest. People collect this down to make soft pillows.



Eider down



Willow ptarmigans are about 17 inches (43 centimeters) in length and live in the Arctic.

Summer visitors



Ruff



Red phalarope



Red-breasted goose



King eider